

The Grandfather Tree

MR nil; SZ L; ML 12; leather barding, medium shield, mace, two javelins each.

Bugbears (10): INT 6; AL CE; AC 9; MV 9; HD 3+1; hp 27; THACO 17; #AT 1; Dmg 1d10+2; MR nil; SZ L; ML 12; leather barding.

Bugbear Leader: INT 8; AL CE; AC 2; MV 9; HD 4+1; hp 27; THACO 17; #AT 1; Dmg 1d4+9; MR nil; SZ L; ML 12; medium shield, scale mail, three javelins, *twin-headed flail* +2.

The rock is moss encrusted and very slick (-45% to climb walls roll). Lying on top of the rock is a large cup made from pure jade inlaid with gold and small, cut gemstones (worth 6,000 gp). The cup is filled by four small, cut, translucent star rubies (worth 1,500 gp each) and two rings with gold bands inset with a large spinel stone of a very deep blue. One ring is nonmagical (worth 850 gp), while the other is a *ring of water walking*.

15A. Trolls And Bugbears Again.

This narrow passage slopes gently down. The walls are lined with tree roots and small rocks. There are two groups in this room, apparently about to have a conflict. A group of three trolls is facing off against ten bugbears.

Should the adventurers watch, the bugbears seem to think that they are in charge and keep gesturing towards the opposite side of the room and motioning for the trolls to go that way. The trolls are too busy licking their lips at the bugbears.

The trolls will eventually attack the bugbears and will slay all but two who will run screaming from the room, while the trolls settle down to eat.

Bugbears (10): INT 6; AL CE; AC 4; MV 9; HD 3+1; hp 27; THACO 17; #AT 1; Dmg 1d10+2; MR nil; SZ L; ML 12; leather barding, medium shield, broad sword, two javelins.

Trolls (3): INT 6; AL CE; AC 4; MV 12; HD 6+6; hp 54; THACO 13; #AT 3; Dmg 2d4+1/2d4+1/3d4; SD regeneration; MR nil; SZ L; ML 14.

The treasure from the bugbears is 10 sp, and 9 gp (Silver's Keep mint), and 4 ep.

16. Pungi Sticks Again.

At this point is another pungi spike pit that can be easily detected. The pit is covered with a tarp sprinkled with dirt.

Should the adventurers actually fall into the trap, roll 1d12 to see how many spikes strike the PC falling into the pit. Damage done is 1d4 per spike.

17A and 17B. Trapped Passages.

A simple trip wire that is easily detected will release 60 darts tipped with sleep poison. Roll 1d10 to see how many darts strike the adventurers and then they have to save versus poison at -2 penalty.

18. Treasure Room.

This large room has a high roof lined with old tree roots. Dotting the room is four large, partially buried ironbound chests. Lying on top of one of the chests is a rotting, cloth wrapped bundle. Breaking into each chest reveals some treasure. Chest #1 holds 60 small diamonds (worth 20 gp each). Chest #2 holds 200 cut rodochrosite stones (worth 5 sp each). Chest #3 holds 100 cut eye agate stones (worth 10 gp each). Chest #4 holds 30 large, cut alexandrite stones (worth 100 gp each).

The cloth wrapped bundle holds a sealed scroll tube that contains four pages of parchment. Each page holds a single cake-mix first-level Necromantic spell: *animate dead animals*, *spectral ears*, *spectral eyes*, and *spectral voice*¹⁰.

19. Lizardmen.

This large room has a small smoky fire in the center around which are grouped, nine, cold, and stiff looking lizardmen dressed in leather barding. As the adventurers, approach they merely look at them and one rises slowly to attempt to talk to the adventurers.

These lizardmen are from an advanced tribe and speak orc, gnoll, bugbear, and hobgoblin. They will not attack the adventurers and wish only to leave. They will tell the adventurers everything they know in exchange for peaceful passage.

Lizardmen (6): INT 11; AL LN; AC 9; MV 6; HD 1; hp 8; THACO 19; SZ M; ML 9 (cold); leather barding, sword, medium shield.

19A. Fresh Water Alcove.

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This small alcove has been eroded by water and forms a small pool of water at the base of the floor.

19B. More Orcs.

This gently curving passage seems ordinary but at the opposite end, just entering the passage is a large group of orcs led by an orc bearing a burning torch and a battle ensign. The flag is that of a giant, black one-eyed spider on a faded blue field dotted with bones and blood. Several pelts hang from the standard pole. Each (except the torchbearer) holds a cocked and loaded heavy, double crossbow with a sheathed short sword and a medium shield slung over their backs. All are wearing decent chain mail over padded leather jerkins to which they have added steel shin and thigh guards. The leader is wearing well-oiled double chain mail. They are mud splattered and dirty but they are still professional looking.

Half-orcs (22): INT 11; AL LE; AC 4; F9; hp 72; THACO 11; #AT 3/2; Dmg 1d6+2 (x2)/1d6; SA poison on both quarrels and sword adds 1d4 points of damage, +1 to damage; *chain mail* +2, *short sword* +1, *double heavy crossbow* +2, 20 barbed quarrels, two phials type A poison, one phial paralyze poison.

Grishnak Short-foe (orog): INT 14; AL LE; AC 1; F11; hp 88; THACO 8; #AT 3/2; Dmg 1d6x3; +1 to damage; *double chain mail* +3; *ring of protection* +2; *short sword of quickness* +3, *dagger of parrying* +2, six *throwing daggers* +1 each envenomed with type D poison, save versus poison or suffer 35 hp; medium shield, 30 gp, 4 cp and 2 ep.

The orcs are from the One-eyed Spider tribe¹¹ from the area north of the Dessarin and the High Forest. A very nefarious orc band known for its ferocity in battle, a large number of professionally trained fighters. The orog is from Tanta Hagara's personal bodyguard.

20. Trapped Passage and Treasure Room.

The door to this room bears three wire traps that will each release a volley of 60 darts. All creatures within 10' of the door will suffer 3d6 points of damage when each trap is triggered.

This room has a single large chest sitting on the dirt floor with two smaller boxes resting on top of it. All the boxes appear very rotten, the locks are now rusted beyond repair, and each must be smashed open. Sitting on the floor is a small group of orcs wearing mud splattered armor. If alerted by the traps on the door, they will have another surprise ready for the adventurers ready by launching a volley of crossbow quarrels at the first adventurer in the door.

Orcs (15): INT 8; AL LE; AC 5; HD 1; hp 8; THACO 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1d6 or 1d8; heavy crossbow, 25 heavy quarrels, broad sword, medium shield.

The largest chest contains 40 trade bars of silver (1,000 sp each, Luskan treasury mint), and 30 uncut pieces of jade (worth 20 gp each). Opening the smaller boxes reveals a mess of old water-damaged parchment and ruined scrolls. Digging through the mess searching for useable material will take two rounds.

Spending two rounds digging through the trash will reveal a small, sealed lead box that will radiate magic strongly. Opening the box will reveal a tome of beaten electrum pages stamped and etched with runes of the spells set down within. Small rings of tarnished black silver secure the four pages. The cover bears a single word written in a long dead language (Shangalar, written in Thorass) on the lower right of the front cover, and is the only lettering or adornment that the cover bears. The book is surprising heavy but is less than a finger thick, and its cover is three hand-widths across by seven hand-widths in height. This tome is the *Book of Shangalar "the Black"*¹².

21. More Bugbears.

The entry to this room has been trapped with a simple trip wire that will drop a large, weighted, belled, and hooked net upon the adventurers. A successful bend bars/lift gates roll is required to escape the net. The noise of the net will bring the bugbears, goblins, and dire wolves running to dinner.

This large room has a domed roof that is 15' high, and the thick smells of smoke drifts from the room. Assuming the assembled creatures in the room have not been alerted, there are 10 bugbears and four of the shorter and stockier species of gnolls (flinds). Lying near the gnolls are four giant, pony-sized wolves (dire wolves).

Bugbears (10): INT 6; AL CE; AC 4; MV 9; HD 3+1; hp 27; THACO 17; #AT 1; Dmg 1d10+2; SZ L; ML 12; medium shield, broad sword.

Flinds (4): INT 9; AL CE; AC 2; MV 12; HD 2+3; hp 22; THACO 17; #AT 2; Dmg 1d4; SA disarm (save versus wands or have weapon entangled and ripped from grasp); SZ L; ML 11; flind bar, chain mail, long sword.

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Dire Wolves (4): INT 9; AL NE; AC 5; MV 18; HD 4+4; hp 36; THACO 15; #AT 1; Dmg 2d4; SZ L; ML 10.

The treasure off these creatures is: 6 gp, 6 cp, 10 sp, and four Silverymoon shining blue crescents¹³ (worth 2 ep each in Silverymoon, but only worth 1 ep everywhere else).

22. The Entrance.

These walls are very high and disappear into the gloom overhead. The smell of smoke hangs in the still air. The earthen floor is littered with numerous tracks, too mixed together to get an accurate count. The dirt floor is soon replaced with flagstones that are littered with muddy prints.

About 10' from the start of the flagstones is a pair of large stone doors that are now open. From the smoke hanging in the air and the cracks in the door, they must have been forcefully opened and that must have set off some magical protection.

Piled in front of the open doors is a pile of 10 freshly killed barbarians dressed in white leather. Standing by the pile is a group of 12 blue leather clad barbarians talking quietly among themselves armed with large war axes and medium shields. There are four bugbears searching for valuables within the pile of dead.

The slain barbarians seem to have wielded brass weapons that were no match for the steel weapons of their foes. On the fringes of this pile are several trolls eating some of the dead. The dead barbarians did not die without taking some of their foes with them as there are several piles of dead orcs, bugbears, and a few of the blue leather clad barbarians.

Blue Bear Tribe Barbarians¹⁴ (12): INT 15; AL LE; AC 4; MV 12; HD 6; hp 48; THACO 12; #AT 3/2; Dmg 1d12+4; war ax, shield.

Bugbears (4): INT 6; AL CE; AC 4; MV 9; HD 3+1; hp 27; THACO 17; #AT 1; Dmg 1d10+2; MR nil; SZ L; ML 12; leather barding, medium shield, long sword.

Trolls (6): INT 6; AL CE; AC 4; MV 12; HD 6+6; hp 54; THACO 13; #AT 3; Dmg 2d4+1/2d4+1/3d4; SD regeneration; MR nil; SZ L; ML 14.

The treasure from these barbarians is 6 gp, 2 sp, and 2 pp.

The Blue Bear Tribe Barbarians are the devoted followers of Tanta Hagara¹⁵ and she has deceived them into thinking that she is the avatar of their demonic bear spirit. They are devoted entirely to her and are under the effects of a *charm person*, *suggestion*, and *geas*.

23. The Stone Dais.

This giant room is lined with thick tree roots and large rocks imbedded in the walls. The arched roof is framed in the same thick roots and seems to disappear into the smoke and gloom overhead. Directly in front of the adventurers is a large cracked stone dais that has the remains of a ruined stone statue scattered about it. From the pieces, it appears to once have been a bear. The eyes may have once held something of value for there are several tool marks and scratches about the empty sockets. A once secret compartment in the back of the bear has been plundered of what it once held.

24. Another Exit to the Surface.

This long narrow passage runs for a very long time to dead end in a large boulder. Pushing aside the stone will require 46 total Strength.

25. The Blackberries.

This very narrow and long tunnel will eventually come onto the surface into a large blackberry bramble. The adventurers will have to hack their way through the bushes to a clearing. When the adventurers finally do clear the blackberries, they find themselves standing on the edge of a 12' round, dry, and cracked stone pool with a statue of Mielikki in the center. Four 10' tall pillars one to each direction on the compass stand on the edge of the pool. The blackberries form an almost impossible wall around this lost shrine.

This pool is sacred to Mielikki and any worshiper of hers who rests here will heal at twice the normal rate and will carry a *bleed* spell for 1d4 days after worshipping here.

26. Entry Into the Hall of Mists.

This room has several dead humanoids and shows the effects of a recent battle. A cloying stench of burnt fur, flesh, and leather hangs in the air. The walls are about 10' apart with a sloping roof about 10' high. The roof is

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different here, having mortised stone walled and a natural earthen roof. The roof and floor show spots where small rocks and dirt fell from the roof. The southeastern corner shows a large singed area where a *fireball* or similar spell was used. Most of the slain are more of the white-clothed humans, two gnolls, and several goblins, orcs, and a three of the blue leather-clad barbarians.

The open double doors from this room seems to had some form of magical trap upon guessing by the pile of dead orcs beside the doors. Apparently, the orcs exhausted the trap by sheer numbers.

27. The First Hallway.

This large room is about 40' wide and 30' long with mortised stone walls and roof. A large group of hobgoblins, orcs, trolls, gnolls, bugbears, and several of the pony-sized wolves and the slightly smaller worgs. Standing in the midst of this gruesome assembly is a startling lovely figure of an 8' tall, blue-skinned, raven-haired, human female barbarian dressed in dark blue leather and bear fur. Clutched in her right hand is a large wooden staff bearing mystic symbols and glowing with a faint light. Beside her is the largest, ugliest troll you have ever seen. This monster is dressed in rusty and muddy iron plate mail and wearing an ancient battered iron helm with a great black sapphire set in the brow, and nine black opals set around the lower edge of the helm. Within the lower edge of the band are three vacant spots where three of the small black opals are missing. This monster is carrying a giant morning star.

Immediately, the woman sees the adventurers and screams in an ear-splitting scream "No, the power of the pool is mine!" She lowers her arm and screams in the orcish tongue for them to attack. Suddenly the seething mass of vile creatures surges at the adventurers.

Hobgoblins (15): INT 9; AL LE; AC 2; MV 9; HD 1+1; hp 9; THACO 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1d10; MR nil; SZ M; ML 12; brigandine mail, glaives, long sword.

Hobgoblin Sergeants/Assistants (3): INT 10; AL LE; AC 1; MV 9; HD 1+1; hp 9; THACO 19; Dmg 1d8 or 1d12; MR nil; SZ M; ML 12; ring mail, medium shield, sword, morning star.

Hobgoblin Subchief: INT 10; AL LE; AC -1; MV 9; HD 2; hp 16; THACO 17; Dmg 1d10+2; MR nil; SZ M; ML 12; brigandine mail, medium shield, broadsword.

Orcs (10): INT 8; AL LE; AC 6; HD 1; hp 8; THACO 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1d6 or 1d8; heavy crossbow, 25 heavy quarrels, broad sword, medium shield.

Trolls (4): INT 6; AL CE; AC 4; MV 12; HD 6+6; hp 54; THACO 13; #AT 3; Dmg 2d4+1/2d4+1/3d4; SD regeneration; MR nil; SZ L; ML 14.

Troll, Giant: INT 6; AL CE; AC -2; MV 12; HD 8; hp 64; THACO 13; #AT 3; Dmg 2d6+7; SD regeneration; MR nil; SZ L; ML 18; *helm of darkness*¹⁶, iron plate mail, morning star.

Gnolls (25): INT 5; AL CE; AC 5; MV 9; HD 2; hp 16; THACO 19; #AT 1; Dmg 2d4; SZ L; ML 11; medium shield, mace, long sword.

Bugbears (4): INT 6; AL CE; AC 0; MV 9; HD 3+1; hp 25; THACO 17; #AT 1; Dmg 1d10+2; SZ L; ML 12; chain mail, long sword, medium shield.

Dire Wolves (4): INT 9; AL NE; AC 5; MV 18; HD 4+4; hp 36; THACO 15; #AT 1; Dmg 2d4; SZ L; ML 10.

Worgs (6): INT 5; AL NE; AC 6; MV 18; HD 3+3; hp 27; THACO 17; #AT 1; Dmg 2d4; MR nil; SZ M; ML 11.

Tanta Hagara (Annis): INT 12; AL CE; AC -3; MV 15; HD 7+7; hp 63; THACO 13; #AT 3; Dmg 1d8+8/1d8+8/2d4+1; SA grapple when all three attacks hit, next attack automatic hits with all attacks, *fog cloud* x3 per day, *change self*; SD edged weapons due one point less damage, blunt weapons due one point more damage; MR 20%; SZ L; ML 15; *ring of protection* +3, *ring of spell turning* 65%, *ring of mind shielding*¹⁷, three loaves of *bread of restoration*¹⁸, *ring of spell storing*¹⁹ with the spells: *light 15' radius*, *teleport without error*, *burning hands*, *shocking grasp*, *color spray*; *wand of armory*²⁰, scrolls: *protection from magical weapons* and *protection from nonmagical weapons*; *necklace of demons*²¹ with seven stones; and a *venom dagger* filled with type D poison, save versus poison or suffer 35 hp.

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The treasure from the assembled mass is 24 gp, 415 cp, 24 sp, 45 ep, and 44 miscellaneous small cut gems (worth 345 gp total).

28. Empty Room.

This cobweb filled room is about 20' wide and 40' long and is covered with a thick layer of dust and cobwebs.

Should the adventurers search the room, they find the layer of dust and cobwebs are unnaturally thick and were laid by some magical means. In the back of the room near the wall is a rune inscribed dais set on the floor. Any creature stepping on this dais and standing still for at least one melee round is immediately *teleported without error* to the lost, ruined, Elven temple city of Mhiilamniir.²²

29. Pillared Room.

This huge, dark room is extremely long (beyond sight range; 80' long) and wide with a flat roof 15' high supported by stone pillars evenly spaced every 10' upon each which rests four empty brass torch scones set five feet off the floor. Each torch scone is formed in the image of a bear head. A heavy layer of dust and cobwebs festoon the room.

After crossing the room, the adventurers discover on the opposite wall a pair of shut gray stone doors flanked by a pair of nine-foot tall stone statues shaped like human women with large clear crystals for eyes.

After searching for hidden or concealed doors, the adventurers will discover two, secret, small compartment in the North wall. Inside the alcove is a small open area that has a single shaft of light inside. Both alcoves are about four-foot high and are trapped with a depression trap that will crush the adventurer inside the alcove, killing them instantly. A thief that successfully rolls his disarm traps proficiency can disarm these traps.

By placing a mirror into the beams of light and deflecting it into the eyes of the statues, the twin stone guardians will be deactivated. The beams of light must be constantly sent into the eyes or when the doors are opened, they will activate, attacking all in the room. When the beams of light strike the stone guardians, an ancient riddle appears in glowing script upon the two doors:

"I sleep by day and fly by night,
The moon hides me from mortal sight.
Reach for me but always fail.
Trust in me when you set sail."²³

The answer is "star" said aloud in the common tongue which will cause the doors to swing silently in to the next room. An incorrect answer will have no effect upon either the door or the riddle.

Stone Guardians (2): INT 6; AL N; AC 5; MV 6; HD 11; hp 88; THACO 9; #AT 1; Dmg 1d8+8; SA emits a *cloud of paralyzation* once per day that effects all creatures within 10' of the statue unless a successful save versus breath weapon is made; SD struck only by magical weapons, edged weapons due a point less damage, blunt weapons due a point more damage; MR nil; SZ L; ML 17.

30. Wet Room.

This 10' wide by 30' long room is dark and quiet. The far West wall is a light green color and has small rivulets of water running down the wall to end in a small pool set in the floor.

Floating in the pool is a silvery crystal globe about the size of an apple. It will radiate magically strongly but will resist all magic but the strongest *legends and lore*. The crystal globe is actually a *book of vile darkness*²⁴ that instantly projects its contents into the person holding the globe with both hands and concentrating on the globe. Under the globe on the bottom of the pool are a few bones and a small number of coins: 2 sp, 7 gp, 40 cp, 2 pp, and five Waterdeep crescent-shaped platinum harbor moons²⁵ (worth 5 gp in Waterdeep; 2 gp everywhere else) minted in the year 1262 during the Guild Wars.

31. Moldy Room.

This room is 10' wide and 30' long and as the doors open, the stench of stale air, mold and rot assault the adventurer's noses. Stacked in the room almost to the roof are numerous rotting bags of grain with large worms and beetles feeding upon the ruined grain.

Adventurers that crawl over the mess of damp grain into the room, find a narrow space in the back of the room in which are stacked seven tar sealed kegs, each holding about 250 gallons. Each is sitting upright with a rubber plug set in the top. Lying on the floor beside the kegs are a tarnished copper ladle and a rotting leather-headed mallet. On top of the nearest keg, turned over on the tops are two lead-crystal glasses coated with a fine layer of dust.

The rubber bungs will disintegrate when pulled but all the kegs are filled with pure grain alcohol.